

Attacks on Health Care

News Brief

10-23 June
2026

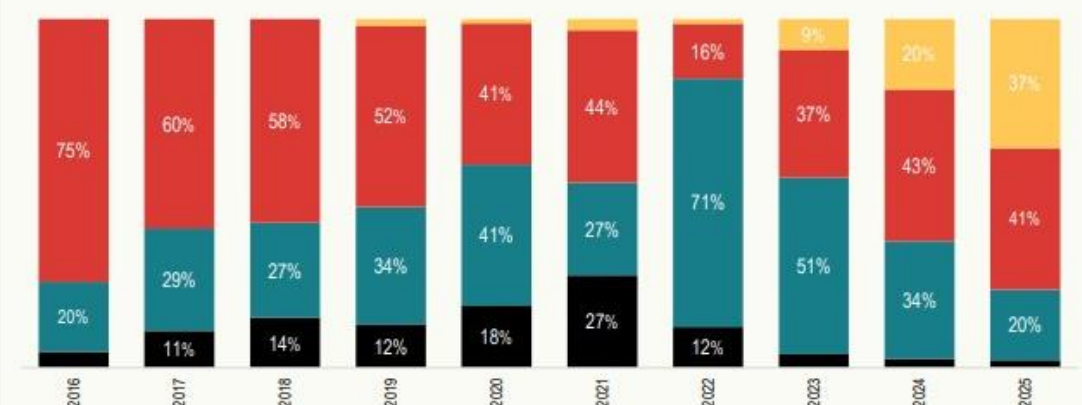
Since the adoption of United Nations Security Council Resolution 2286 in 2016 and 09 June 2026, Insecurity Insight has documented over **19,000** attacks on health care worldwide, highlighting the persistent and widespread failure to protect health care in conflict.

To mark a decade since the adoption, Insecurity Insight released a landmark report analysing ten years of violence against health care. Drawing on a decade of systematically collected data, ***Still Under Attack*** documents the scale, patterns, and consequences of attacks on health care in conflict-affected settings around the world. Among the report's key findings:

- More than 3,860 health workers were killed and over 2,500 were arrested or detained between January 2016 and December 2025.
- Local health workers remain particularly vulnerable, accounting for more than 65% of documented health worker killings.
- The growing use of armed drones and explosive weapons is contributing to increasing damage to health facilities and to health worker deaths and injuries.

Attacks on health care where explosives were used, by delivery type, 2016-2025

Over the past decade, airstrikes have evolved from being conducted almost exclusively by state forces using manned aircraft to increasingly involving drones used by both state and non-state actors, raising important IHL responsibilities related to planning, authorisation, and targeting decisions.



Incident where aircraft-delivered explosives were used (2,169) Incident where directly emplaced explosives were used (328)
Incident where drone-delivered explosives were used (758) Incident where ground-delivered explosives were used (1,912)

Source: Insecurity Insight



Based exclusively on Insecurity Insight's data collection, the report shows how violence against health care has become increasingly normalised, with severe consequences for civilians, disease response, and the resilience of health systems. The report also provides detailed analysis of perpetrators, methods of attack, and emerging risks, including the growing role of new technologies in conflict. It concludes with recommendations for governments, international organisations, humanitarian actors, and the diplomatic community to strengthen the protection of health care and improve accountability for violations.

Past editions: [27 May-09 June](#); [13-26 May](#); [29 April-12 May](#); [15-28 April](#); [01-14 April](#); [18-31 March](#); [04-17 March](#); [18 February-03 March](#); [04-17 February](#); [21 January-03 February](#); [07-20 January](#); [24 December-06 January](#); [All](#)

SHCC Reports: [2025;2024](#); [2023](#); [2022](#); [2021](#); [All](#)

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SHCC Attacks on Health Care

The section aligns with the [definition](#) of attacks on health care used by the [Safeguarding Health in Conflict Coalition](#) (SHCC).

Africa

Democratic Republic of the Congo

13 June 2026: In Watsa territory, Haut-Uele province, the head nurse at Mungbere General Referral Hospital was shot and killed by a soldier who was reportedly attempting to speak to a patient receiving treatment, and the nurse was shot while intervening to inquire about the situation and protect the patient. **Source:** [Radio Okapi](#)

As reported on 14 June 2026: In Mongbwalu town, Djugu territory, Ituri province, health workers burying a suspected Ebola casualty were violently obstructed from accessing a coffin by residents. Police officers warned residents not to touch the coffin but were later forced to use warning shots and tear gas to allow health workers to retrieve the body. **Source:** [Personal Communication](#)

15 June 2026: In Wanamahika Mutiri area, Butembo city, North Kivu province, Adventist (Wanamahika) Hospital was stormed by unidentified armed men carrying bladed weapons and knives, who abducted a woman and her six-year-old daughter from the facility. The child had tested positive for Ebola. The mother and daughter were later found at an Ebola treatment centre roughly 18km from Butembo. **Sources:** [Actualite](#), [AOL](#), [BBC](#) and [Reuters](#)

16 June 2026: In Ituri province, five Ebola response workers were briefly kidnapped by armed groups. **Sources:** [Namibia Daily News](#) and [United Nations](#)

16 June 2026: In Kakumba village, Walungu territory, South Kivu province, two Red Cross workers wearing Red Cross emblems were killed by armed men while on a mission to supervise drinking water supply work. The armed men allegedly knew the nature of their mission in the area. **Sources:** [ICRC](#) and [Radio Okapi](#)

Insecurity Insight's latest social media monitoring brief analyses public narratives surrounding the 17th Ebola epidemic in the Democratic Republic of the Congo between 15 June to 22 June 2026. **Key findings:**

- Politics, not the outbreak, drove the conversation. Comment volume rose 33% on the previous period, but almost entirely on the back of a single statement by an opposition figure linking the DRC's World Cup performance to governance failures (1,160 comments, 26.5% of the total). Harmful content stayed minimal in posts and scattered in comments.
- A government attempt to deflect criticism onto an NGO backfired. After a health organisation warned of "dangerous gaps" in the response, the government rejected the criticism as "alarmist" and urged NGOs to show restraint. The backlash was overwhelmingly hostile to the government rather than the NGO, and dominated by the "Ebola business" corruption frame.
- A cluster of attacks on Ebola facilities and health workers was amplified and reframed online. The incidents are real and corroborated, but their online life was driven by a small network of accounts - and the single highest-reach post had over 400,000 views.

Read the brief in [English](#) and [French](#). Visit our [website](#) for precious briefs.

Data from Insecurity Insight shows that since 21 May and 21 June 2026, at least **19 incidents** of violence against or obstruction of health care impacting Ebola response measures were reported. Two Ebola treatment facilities were attacked and deliberately set on fire and another vandalised, damaging windows and a water supply system, compromising access to drinking water. Health workers were repeatedly assaulted, threatened and violently obstructed from performing their duties.

Ethiopia

13 June 2026: In Sir Iyasus kebele, Enemay woreda, East Gojjam zone, south-western Amhara region, a health facility was looted by ENDF members during a raid in the area. **Source:** **Amhara Association of America**

Nigeria

21 June 2026: In Kawel village, Mushere district, Bokkos local government area, Plateau state, a primary health centre was attacked by gunmen with guns and machetes at around 2330hrs, killing 22 people, including an unspecified number of health workers and patients. **Source:** **Daily Trust**

Sudan

Data from Insecurity Insight shows that since fighting started between the SAF and RSF in April 2023 and 09 June 2026 at least **761 incidents** of violence against or obstruction of access to health care took place across Sudan:

- Over two-thirds of these 761 attacks were attributed to the RSF
- 211 health workers were killed, 15 kidnapped and 127 arrested
- Health facilities were damaged 216 times
- 63 attacks where armed drones affected health care
- 51 attacks on maternal health care services

Incident briefs: 10-23 June; 27 May-09 June; 13-26 May; 29 April-12 May; 15-28 April; 01-14 April; 18-31 March; 04-17 March; 18 February-03 March; 04-17 February; 21 January-03 February; 07-20 January; All

SHCC chapters (EN): 2025; 2024; 2023; 2022; 2021. (AR): 2025; 2024; 2023; 2022; 2021

Asia

Pakistan

Between 05 June - 01 July 2026: In Quetta city, Balochistan province, a female doctor was attacked and severely burned with acid inside the Civil Hospital by a hospital lift operator. A medical technician was also burned when he rushed to help the doctor. The lift operator was later shot and killed by police who tracked him down at a local bus station. In response to the acid attack, doctors staged protests in Quetta. **Sources:** **Arab News**, **Ians Live** and **The Jerusalem Post**

Myanmar

Data collected by Insecurity Insight shows that since the military coup on 01 February 2021 and 04 June 2026 at least **1,943 incidents** of violence against or obstruction of access to health care took place across Myanmar:

- equivalent to one attack on health care every day for more than five years
- 65% of these attacks were attributed to the Myanmar Armed Forces (MAF)
- 175 health workers were killed and 932 arrested
- health facilities were damaged on at least 509 occasions

So far this year, at least seven health workers were killed by explosive weapons. Five health workers were killed in three incidents involving MAF airstrikes: two occurred at prisoner-of-war detention facilities under the control of opposition forces in Rakhine and Yangon, while the third involved the bombing of a hospital located in areas under the control of the PDF in Sagaing. A further two health workers were killed in two separate roadside landmine

explosions reportedly attributed to opposition forces in Bago and Magway regions.

Incident briefs: [10-23 June](#); [27 May-09 June](#); [13-26 May](#); [29 April-12 May](#); [15-28 April](#); [01-14 April](#); [18-31 March](#); [04-17 March](#); [18 February-03 March](#); [04-17 February](#); [21 January-03 February](#); [07-20 January](#); [All](#)

SHCC chapters: Burmese: [2025](#); [2024](#); [2023](#). English: [2025](#); [2024](#); [2023](#); [2022](#); [2021](#); [2020](#)

Europe

Ukraine

10 June 2026: In Industrialnyi district, Kharkiv city, raion and oblast, a private dental clinic and apartments were damaged when a Russian drone fell near a residential building, sparking a fire.

Source: [UA Varta](#)

11-12 June 2026: In Hlukhiv city and urban hromada, Shostka raion, Sumy oblast, a pharmacy and shops inside a shopping centre were damaged in an overnight drone attack by Russian forces.

Source: [Kordon Media](#)

13 June 2026: In Bilopillia city and urban hromada, Sumy raion and oblast, a 64-year-old nurse was killed after a Russian drone hit their car around 0730hrs. Her acquaintance who was driving was also injured. The nurse worked in the interventional radiology department of the Central City Clinical Hospital of the Sumy City Council. **Sources:** [Central City Clinical Hospital](#), [Kordon Media](#), [Odin Doma Sumy](#) and [The Sumy Post](#)

15 June 2026: In Kushugum rural settlement and settlement hromada, Zaporizhzhia raion and oblast, a parked ambulance was hit by a Russian drone strike on the territory of a medical facility. A female nurse was injured and the ambulance caught fire. **Sources:** [InformZP](#), [MIG](#), [Regio News](#), [State Emergency Service of Zaporizhzhia](#), [The Head of Zaporizkaya OVA](#) and [UA Varta](#)

18 June 2026: In Pidserednie village, Prykolotne rural settlement, Kupiansk raion, Kharkiv oblast, an ambulance was damaged by Russian shelling. **Source:** [UA Varta](#)

20 June 2026: In Nikopol raion, Dnipropetrovsk oblast, a pharmacy and other civilian infrastructure were damaged in a Russian attack on the oblast with artillery, missiles and drones. **Sources:** [057](#), [Apostrophe](#), [Censor](#), [Dnepr Express](#), [Dnipro Media](#), [Dnipro News](#), [DniproTV](#), [DSNews](#), [Hirchytstva](#), [Interfax](#), [Informator](#), [Nikopolnews](#), [Ukrainian Truth](#), [Ukrinform](#) and [Vidomo](#)

Insecurity Insight has documented over [3,000 attacks](#) on Ukraine's health facilities, health workers and infrastructure since the start of Russia's full-scale invasion on 24 February 2022 to 30 April 2026, averaging nearly two attacks per day.

- Hospitals and clinics have been damaged or destroyed 1,632 times
- 462 health workers have been killed and 476 others injured.
- 113 attacks on services provided for women during pregnancy, childbirth and the postnatal period

Explore this [interactive map](#) - a joint undertaking among Insecurity Insight, eyeWitness to Atrocities (eyeWitness), Media Initiative for Human Rights (MIHR), Physicians for Human Rights (PHR), Truth Hounds, and the Ukrainian Healthcare Center (UHC) - to see where incidents took place. Available in [English](#) and [Ukrainian](#). Map filters include attacks on maternal and childcare services, military use of health facilities and attacks impacting energy and water supplies.

SHCC Chapters: EN: [2025](#); [2024](#); [2023](#); [2022](#). UK: [2025](#); [2024](#); [2023](#)

Middle East and North Africa

Lebanon

10 June 2026: In Haris municipality, Bint Jbeil district, South governorate, two Al-Risala Association paramedics were injured in an Israeli airstrike. **Sources:** [Lebanese Ministry of Public and 26 September](#)

10 June 2026: In Tyre city and district, South governorate, MSF temporarily suspended activities, including its mobile clinics and support to Jabal Amel Hospital, Qana Hospital and the Lebanese-Italian Hospital, following large-scale evacuation orders issued by the Israeli army covering Tyre, its camps and several surrounding areas. MSF evacuated its teams to Sidon and stated that the suspension was due to the forced displacement of residents and the deteriorating security situation. **Source:** [Syrian Arab News Agency](#)

11 June 2026: In Tyre district, South governorate, the vicinity of Hiram Hospital was hit by an Israeli airstrike, injuring 10 nurses and hospital staff members. Patient rooms and the emergency department were damaged, and windows were shattered in staff vehicles. **Sources:** [Drop Site](#) and [UN News](#)

21 June 2026: In Sidon city, Tyre district, South governorate, a pregnant nurse was killed in an Israeli airstrike. **Source:** [Quds News Network](#)

Occupied Palestinian territory

Data collected by Insecurity Insight shows that between 07 October 2023 and 09 June 2026, at least 3,327 incidents of violence against or obstruction of access to health care took place across the occupied Palestinian territory.¹ 95% of all incidents were attributed to Israeli forces.

- **Gaza:** 2,328 attacks on health care were recorded during which health facilities were damaged 448 times, 765 health workers were killed and 398 arrested.² Patient access to medicine was obstructed on 289 occasions.
- **West Bank and East Jerusalem:** 938 attacks on health care were recorded during which health facilities were damaged 30 times, 12 health workers were killed and 188 arrested. Patient access to medicine was obstructed on 579 occasions.

Of the 938 attacks on health care in the West Bank, 47 were attributed to Israeli settlers, who were typically armed with guns or rocks. The proportion of such attacks more than doubled in **2025** compared to 2024, rising from around 2% to 9% of total reported attacks. Between 01 January and 09 June 2026, Israeli settler-attributed attacks increased further, accounting for 22% of all reported attacks during that period. Most Israeli settler attacks on health care targeted ambulances and first responders, including blocking their access to those needing care. On at least seven occasions, Israeli settlers attacked health care under the protection of the IDF.

Incident briefs: [10-23 June](#); [27 May-09 June](#); [13-26 May](#); [29 April-12 May](#); [15-28 April](#); [01-14 April](#); [18-31 March](#); [04-17 March](#); [18 February-03 March](#); [04-17 February](#); [21 January-03 February](#); [07-20 January](#); [All](#)

SHCC Factsheets (EN): [2025](#); [2024](#); [2023](#); [2022](#); [2021](#). (AR): [2025](#); [2024](#); [2023](#); [2022](#); [2021](#).

Syrian Arab Republic

As reported on 15 June 2026: In Ar Raqqa city and governorate, the vicinity of the National Hospital and Intifada School was under threat when the Interior Ministry was attacked in a suicide bombing by unidentified perpetrators, killing two employees of the Interior Ministry. One of the attackers was killed by intervening security forces, while the other was killed in the detonation. **Source:** [Al Bilad Press](#)

Yemen

11 June 2026: In Al-Darain area, Sheikh Othman district, Aden city, two doctors who were husband and wife, both employed at Doctors' Tower Hospital, were shot and killed alongside two Yemeni

soldiers, and an unspecified number of others were wounded, when a soldier guarding the home of the governor of Yemen opened fire in the morning. The soldier was later killed during an attempted arrest by security forces. **Sources:** [Al Bilad](#), [Al Montasaf](#), [The Independent](#) and [Yemen Shabab](#)

The Americas

Colombia

18 June 2026: In García Herreros neighbourhood, Cúcuta city, Norte de Santander department, a pharmacy was robbed and an employee threatened and hit by two men armed with pistols. Cash was stolen from the register. **Source:** [Cucuta Online](#)

Haiti

18-19 April 2026: In Port-au-Prince city and arrondissement, MSF staff members were trapped in their homes during clashes between rival armed groups with intense gunfire. Nearly 40 people, including the MSF staff and their families, sought refuge in the MSF hospital in Cité Soleil, having no other safe option. **Source:** [MSF](#)

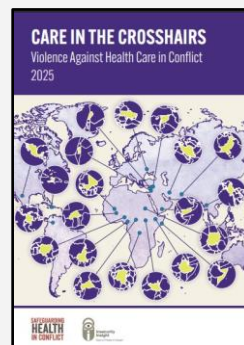
15 June 2026: In Cité Soleil, Port-au-Prince city and arrondissement, the MSF-supported Isaïe Jeanty Maternity Hospital was hit and damaged by numerous stray bullets amid crossfire between armed groups. A woman was injured in the leg by a stray bullet inside the hospital grounds. MSF suspended activities the next morning but continued to provide emergency care, patients' stabilisation and referrals for several days. On 19 June, the organisation evacuated its staff and suspended all activities. **Source:** [MSF](#)

Other resources

Attacks on health care were relentless in 2025. Using data collected by Insecurity Insight, the Safeguarding Health in Conflict Coalition (SHCC) recorded **2,546 incidents in 33 countries** in which damage to or the destruction of health care facilities was reported on at least 790 occasions, 455 health workers were killed, 218 kidnapped and 263 arrested.

Key findings in 2025

- Violence rose in 13 countries and recorded incidents remained far above the ten-year annual average.
- Continued high levels of violence by state forces alongside rising levels of violence by non-state armed actors.
- The expansion of remotely piloted aerial systems (drones) increasingly affected health care in conflict settings.
- Kidnapping of health workers increased, particularly in the Central African Republic, Colombia, the DRC, Mali, Pakistan and Syria.



The report includes detailed profiles of 21 countries and territories where many acts of violence against health care by state parties and non-state armed groups, including organized criminal groups, took place. These include:

Africa: **Burkina Faso**, **Cameroon**, the **CAR**, the **DRC**, **Ethiopia**, **Mali**, **Nigeria**, **Somalia**, **South Sudan** and **Sudan**
Asia: **Myanmar** and **Pakistan**

The Middle East and Europe: **Lebanon**, **Iran**, the **occupied Palestinian territory**, **Syria**, **Ukraine** and **Yemen**

The Americas: **Colombia**, **Haiti** and **Mexico**

Year in Review: **2025**; **2024**; **2023**

Global Health Conference: The Right to Health in Times of War

Bringing together health professionals, researchers, and activists, the conference will examine why medical neutrality is being eroded, what this means for affected populations in and beyond the immediate line of fire, and how health can be protected under conditions of violence.

The program includes a keynote by **Christina Wille** (Insecurity Insight/Safeguarding Health in Conflict Coalition) as well as workshops with experts from Sudan, Lebanon, and Ukraine, including **Hind Altaif** (Emergency Response Rooms Sudan) and **Dr. Zeina Mohanna** (Amel Association International, Lebanon). The conference will address health systems under strain beyond active conflict zones, focusing on the militarisation and gradual erosion of health care as well as the ethical implications of these developments. Contributors include **Prof. Dr. Yudit Namer** (University of Twente) and the **Gesundheitskollektiv Berlin**.

Date: 12 September 2026, 0930-1700 CET

Location: Refugio Berlin

Register [here](#). Space is limited - we encourage you to secure your spot early.

This Bi-Monthly News Brief comprises threats and violence as well as protests and other events affecting the delivery of and access to health care. It is part of the Attacks on Health Care project by Insecurity Insight. It is prepared from information available in local, national and international news outlets and online databases. The incidents reported are not a complete nor a representative list of all events that affected the provision of health care and have not been independently verified. All decisions made, on the basis of, or with consideration to, such information remains the responsibility of their respective organisations. Please **get in touch** if you are interested in curated datasets, if you have made a public statement that you would like us to include in our Bi Monthly News Brief, to report an incident or if you have additional information on an incident we have reported on. Join our [mailing list](#).

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<https://bit.ly/10-23Jun2026Health>

